

- **Take time to rest.** While it may seem like the optimum time to rush through a long “to-do” list, it’s important to conserve your energy for the birth, and the weeks after.
- **Prepare your hospital bag,** or anything you may need for a [home birth](#).
- **Make a list** of everyone you’d like contacted after the birth.
- **Put together some natural remedies** to help you through labor and its aftermath. Lavender oil can be sniffed during labor to relax and calm. You may need ice packs if you end up having an episiotomy (placing ice pads or chilled witch hazel pads on the area may soothe your pain). Ask your doctor about safe pain medications for after delivery, or, if you want to avoid medications, ask him or her for drug-free suggestions.
- **Prepare a few freezer meals.** There is nothing better than having an already prepared, meal on hand in those early weeks.
- **Sort your baby’s new clothes** into sizes, so you don’t find yourself searching through piles to find something that fits.
- **Get a manicure, pedicure, or massage.** Not only will time be tight after your baby arrives, but money may be, too!
- **Produce something creative**—paint your baby’s nursery, cross-stitch a little pillow or picture, make a crib bumper, start a scrapbook, or simply write a letter to your baby to put in a keepsake box. These personal touches are satisfying, and will be treasured for years to come.
- **Catch up with friends and family for lunch.** It may be some time before you feel like going out again when you’re getting used to being a parent and enjoying your new baby in the comfort of your home.